

1 Temple Tribulation Operation Bluestar, 1984

Apparently led by completely off-the-mark intelligence reports, the Indian Army stormed the Golden Temple complex at Amritsar in Operation Bluestar of June 4-6, 1984, killing 492 civilians and 83 armymen. "And now, pushed to the wall, Mrs Gandhi finally did what few could deny had to be done: she gave the signal for Operation Bluestar," said INDIA TODAY in June 1984.

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biggest national security failures

Security can get lax, or even worse, be missing completely. It's a failure in either case, and India is no stranger to the pain every such chapter of ineptitude leaves behind. Ten of the worst, from Amritsar to Mumbai.

2 Enemy Within Indira Killed, 1984

It was a political assassination that shocked the nation perhaps as profoundly as that of Mahatma Gandhi in 1948. On the morning of October 31, 1984, prime minister Indira Gandhi had an appointment with well-known actor Peter Ustinov to record an interview. But it was an appointment she could not keep. "She died in the one contingency that her legion of security officials had been unable to guard against: traitors from within her own security guards," said INDIA TODAY in November 1984.

